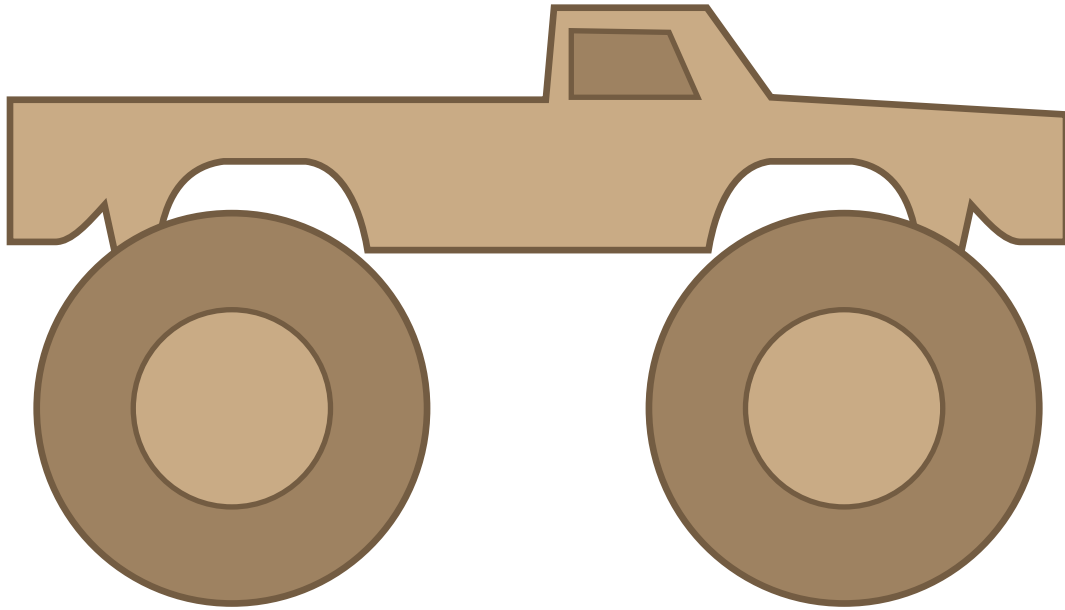




CLASSIC MONSTER TRUCK

step by step guide



MEASURE TWICE • CUT ONCE • HAVE FUN

Cardboard Studio — our family workshop



What you need

MATERIALS

- Corrugated cardboard — a LOT (about 6 large boxes; the chassis core alone is 24 layers)
- Wood glue or white glue (a big bottle)
- Two 1/4-inch wooden dowels, 7 inches long
- Paint or markers for flames and mud splatter

HARDWARE

- 1/4-inch wooden dowel, 7 inches long ×2 — craft store, hardware store, or the garage

TOOLS

- Craft knife and spare blades (grown-up job!)
- Metal ruler
- Pencil
- Awl or 5/16-inch drill bit for the axle holes (grown-up job!)
- Saw or strong snips to cut the dowels (grown-up job!)
- Printer + tape for the template

FINISHED SIZE	DIFFICULTY	BUILD TIME	AGES
12.85" x 7.4"	3 of 3	2-3 hours (plus glue drying overnight)	6+ with a grown-up

SAFETY: Craft knives and hot glue are for grown-ups. Kids trace, fold, tape and decorate!



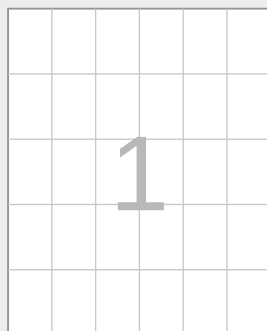
Paper size

INTERNATIONAL (EUROPEAN)

A4



210 x 297 mm
8-1/4 x 11-3/4 in



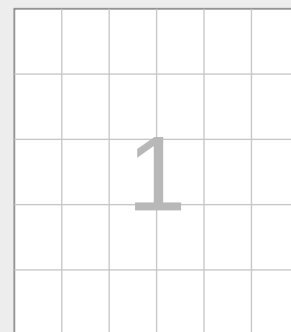
Template part has more height

NORTH AMERICA

Letter size



8.5 x 11 in
216 x 279 mm



Template part has more width



NOTE - printer set up



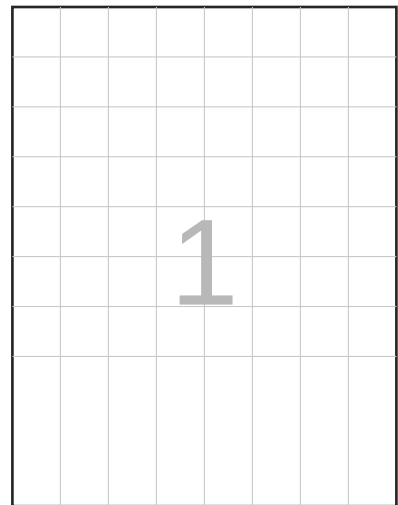
Be sure your printer
is set to print in 100%
ACTUAL SIZE



Print

Page Sizing & Handling

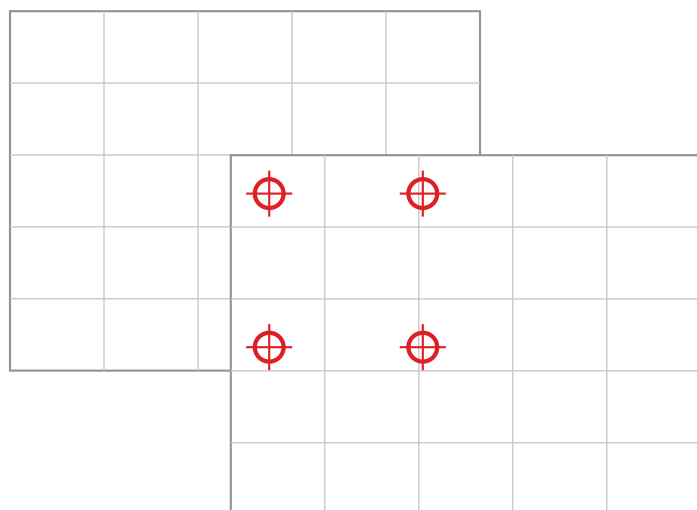
- ☐ Fit
- ☒ **Actual size** ✓
- ☐ Shrink oversized pages
- ☐ Custom Scale: 100%



Page 1 of 10

By default settings the printer shrinks the image to fit its printing area and your template will come out smaller. Each printer has its own paper margin and will not print right to the edge — that is OK: every page includes extra overlap so no detail is lost.

Pages overlap and positioning



① **Overlap**

All pages include an extra margin for overlap, so no details of the template are lost. The exact overlap depends on your printer.

② **1 inch grid (2.54 cm) / 3 inch grid (7.62 cm)**

The grid helps you align the pages perfectly in place. Light lines are 1 inch apart; heavy lines are 3 inches apart.

③ **3x3 inch square**

Overlap the pages until the visible squares measure exactly 1 inch and the heavy lines form 3x3 inch squares — your pattern will automatically align. Tape the pages together.

Your template pages arrange like this:



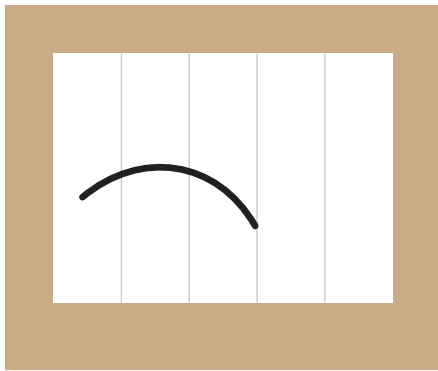
LINE UP THE GRID — THEN TAPE THE PAGES

Tracing

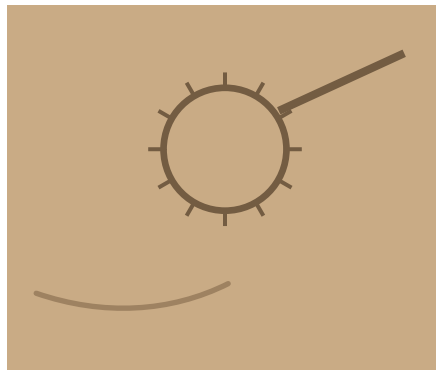
Method 1.

1. Cut Out the Template: carefully cut out the shapes from the printed template using scissors.
2. Secure the Template: place the template pieces on the cardboard and secure with tape or small weights so nothing slips.
3. Trace the Outline: use a pencil or pen to trace around the edges of the template onto the cardboard.
4. Check Your Lines: double-check every piece is traced before removing the template.

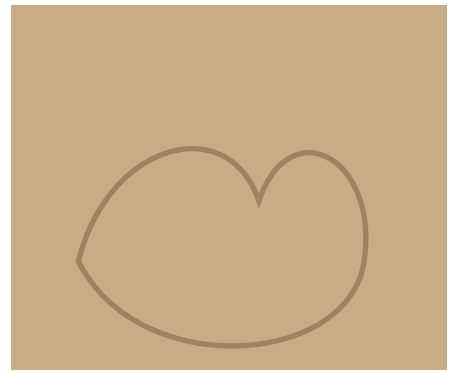
Method 2.



- ① Tape it
and trace it



- ② Tracing tool
a pen with pressure, or a tracing
wheel



- ③ Ready to cut out

NOTE - mind cardboard structure direction

The arrow on each template part shows the direction of the corrugated cardboard flutes. Keep the arrow parallel to the little waves inside your cardboard — parts stay strong and bend where they should.

Tip: the best way to bend cardboard smoothly is to cut slits halfway through on one side. Crease the slits with your fingernail to bend the other way and keep the front smooth.





NOTE - tips and tricks



HOW TO CUT CARDBOARD

PERFECT STRAIGHT CUT

Use a sharp blade and a metal ruler. Cut in 2–3 light passes instead of one hard press.

CUT A PAPER BLEED

Measure your cardboard thickness, cut half through, then peel off the corrugated layer leaving one paper face. Glue sticks much better on the bleed.

CUT A PERFECT CIRCLE

Mark the radius on a cardboard scrap, poke a pin through one end and a pencil through the other — instant compass. Cut just outside the line, then trim.



HOW TO GLUE CARDBOARD

QUICK CONNECTION — HOT GLUE

Fix the panels with tape first, open the joint like a book, run hot glue in the groove, close and tape again. Quick and sturdy for small parts.

BIG PANELS — WHITE GLUE

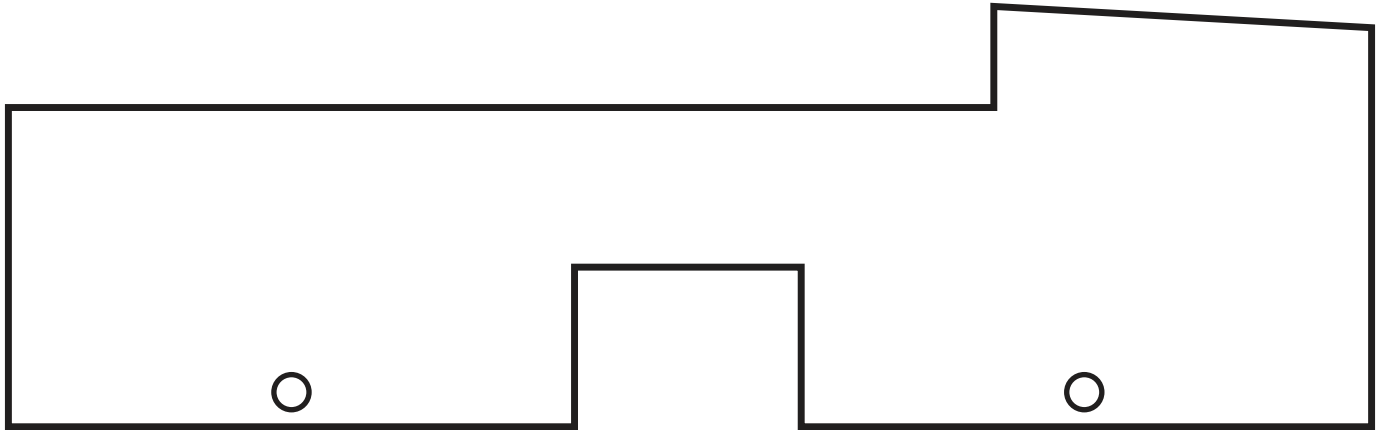
Add a little water to white glue and mix. Spread on the bottom part, lay the top parts like a mosaic so they overlap seams, press under books and let dry completely.

SEAMLESS OVERLAP

Make a paper bleed on the edges, apply white glue on the bottom part and the bleed, connect the matching parts, press and let dry.



Step 1. Print, tape and trace



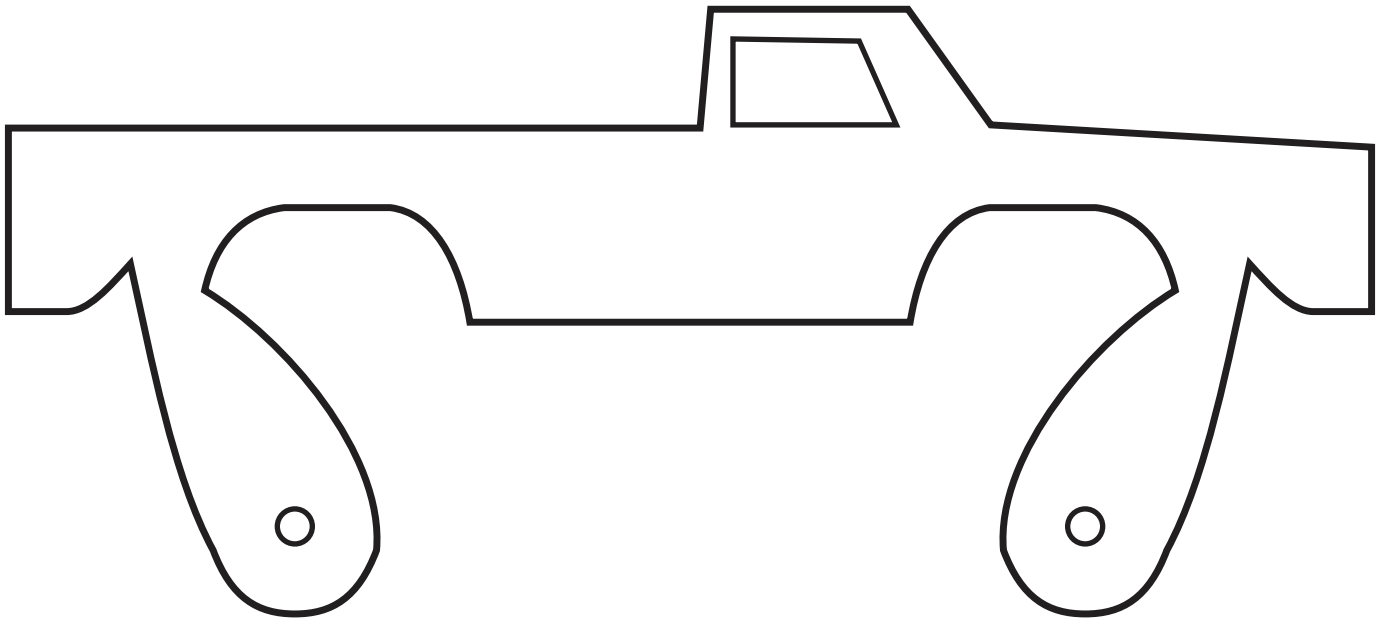
① Chassis Core — trace this 24 times. Yes, 24!

1. Print at 100% actual size and tape the pages together on the grid lines.
2. Trace 24 Chassis Cores, 2 Truck Sides, 1 Hood + Roof Wrap, 1 Bed Floor, 1 Tailgate, 36 Wheel Discs and 4 Wheel Face Rings.
3. Line the corrugation arrow up with the flutes inside the cardboard every time.

TIP: Cut ONE Chassis Core first, then use it as a stencil for the other 23 — much faster than tracing.



Step 2. Cut, score and punch

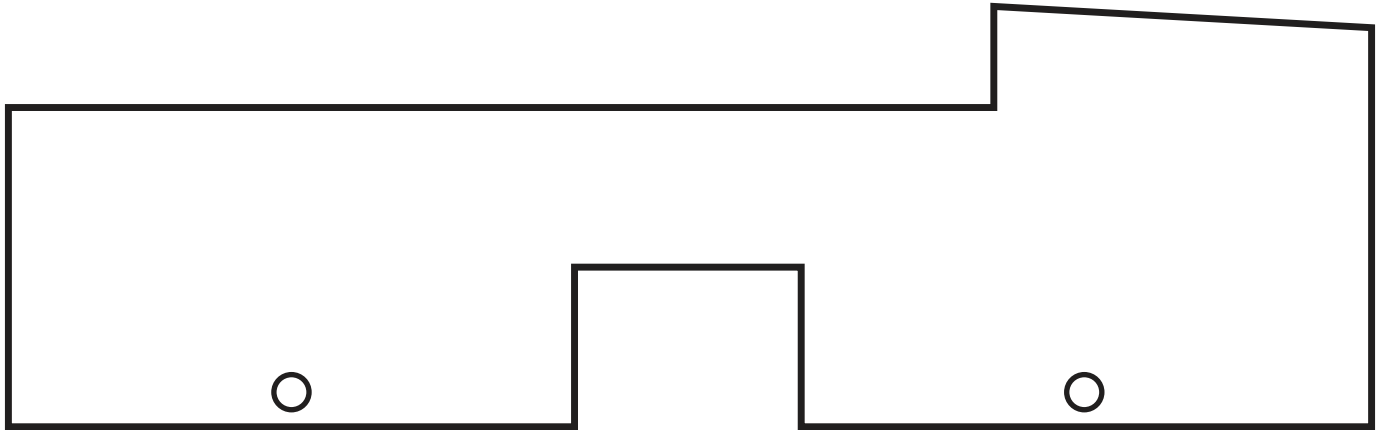


① Truck Side — window and arches cut out, tab legs left on.

1. Grown-up job: cut every solid line with a sharp knife and metal ruler, in 2-3 light passes.
2. Score the two dashed lines on the Wrap and the dashed tread lines on the wheels HALF-deep only — never cut through.
3. Grown-up job: punch the 5/16-inch axle holes in all 24 cores and both sides, and the small centre hole in all 36 discs.



Step 3. Stack the 24-layer chassis core



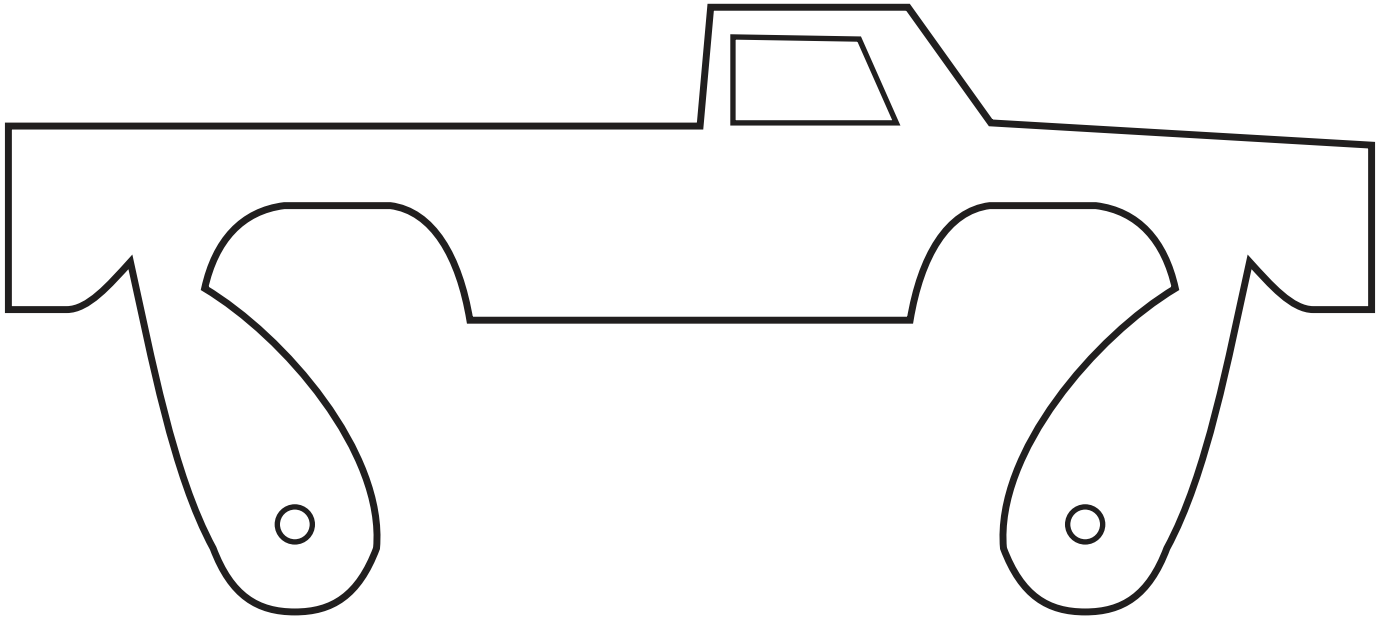
① Chassis Core ×24 — glued into one 3.6-inch-thick chassis.

1. Slide both dowels through two cores to line the axle tunnels up perfectly, then glue those two face to face.
2. Keep adding glued layers down the dowels until all 24 are stacked — spread glue right to the edges.
3. Slide the dowels back out and press the chassis flat under books overnight.

TIP: Wood glue is far stronger than hot glue here — the overnight wait is worth it.



Step 4. Hang the sides on the chassis

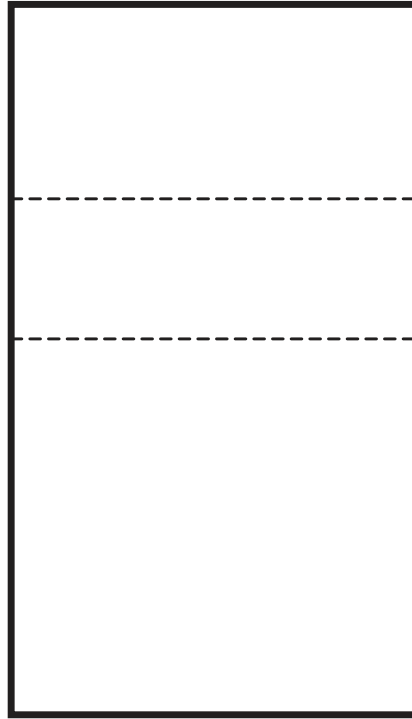


① Truck Side ×2 — tab-leg holes lined up with the axle tunnels.

1. Slide the dowels through the chassis again and thread a Truck Side onto each end so every tab hole lines up.
2. Glue each side to the core face: bed wall against the floor platform, nose edge flush with the core nose.
3. The tab legs sandwich the core at the axles — clamp them flat while the glue grabs.



Step 5. Bed floor, tailgate and the hood wrap



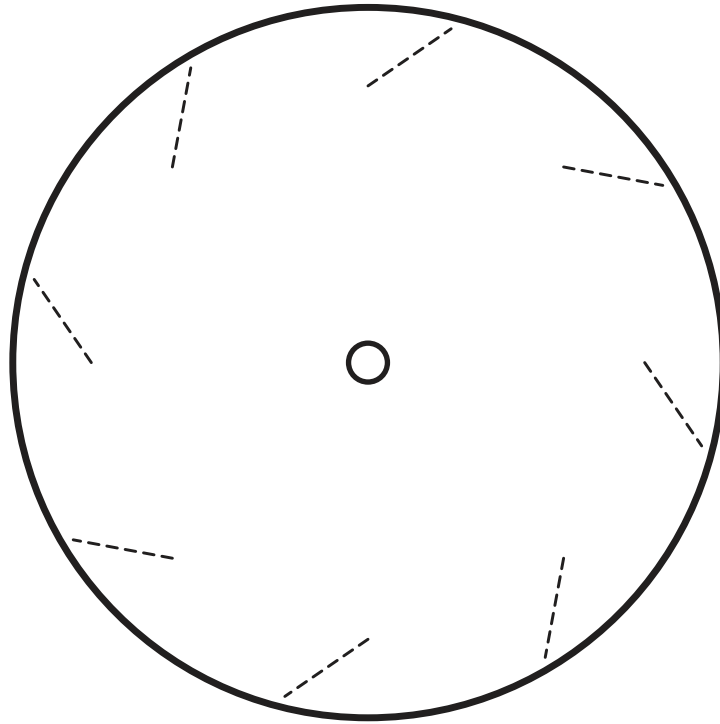
① Hood + Roof Wrap — crease at the two score lines.

1. Drop the Bed Floor onto the chassis platform between the sides and glue it — the bed stays OPEN for cargo.
2. Glue the Tailgate across the back of the bed, tucked between the two sides.
3. Crease the Wrap at both score lines, then glue it on: roof first, windshield leaning back, hood meeting the nose.

TIP: Crease the wrap over a table edge for two dead-straight bends.



Step 6. Build four fat wheels



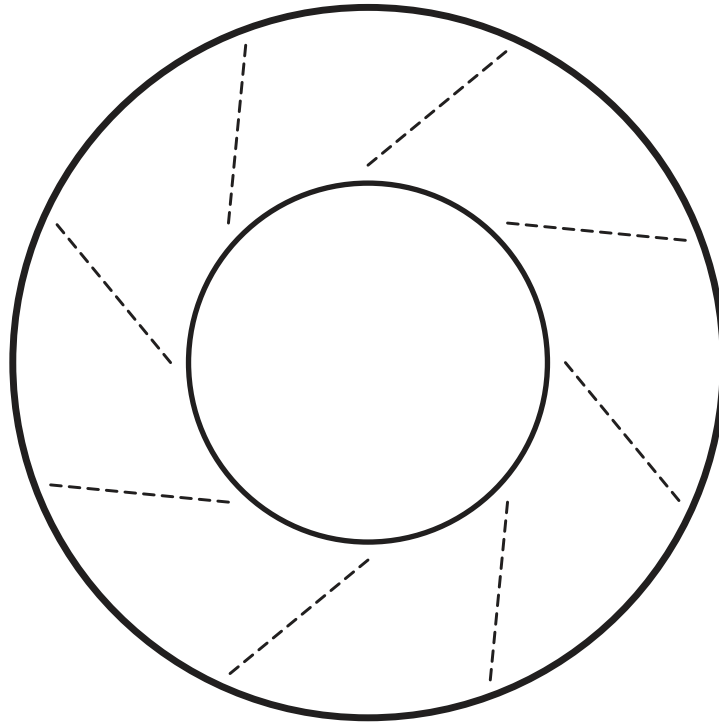
① Wheel Disc $\times 36$ — nine discs make one 1.35-inch-thick wheel.

1. Thread 9 Wheel Discs onto a spare dowel so the hub holes line up, gluing each disc to the next.
2. Glue a Wheel Face Ring on the outside of each stack for the recessed-hub look.
3. Make four wheels, slide them off the dowel and let them dry.

TIP: Sand around each rim so the wheels roll round instead of lumpy.

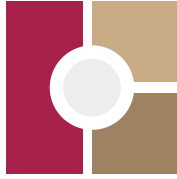


Step 7. Fit the axles and go



① Wheel Face ×4 — dowel ends sit inside the recessed hubs.

1. Push one dowel through each axle line: tab, core tunnel, tab — it must spin freely the whole way.
2. Grown-up job: glue the DOWEL ENDS only, then press a wheel onto each end. Never glue inside the tunnels.
3. Leave a dime of daylight between wheels and tabs, let it dry, then load the bed and race it.



CARDBOARD STUDIO

MADE AT HOME, FOR HOME.

This template was designed in our family workshop. Print it, build it, smash it, rebuild it better. Share it with friends — and send us a photo of what you made!

BUILT WITH

Cardboard Studio

Design: Classic Monster Truck • 2026